Dubai Law No. (4) of 2020 Regulating Unmanned Aircraft in the Emirate of Dubai

As amended by Law No. (10) of 2023 - Official Legislation Portal (dlp.dubai.gov.ae)

Regulatory Domain: Dubai Civil Aviation Authority (DCAA) / Dubai Sky Dome

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Article (5) - Powers of DCAA and Dubai Sky Dome

The Dubai Civil Aviation Authority (DCAA) shall design, manage, and oversee the 'Dubai Sky Dome' infrastructure as an integrated virtual airspace for unmanned aircraft operations. DCAA shall establish mandatory aerial corridors, designate takeoff/landing vertiports, integrate drone traffic management (UTM), and coordinate real-time airspace clearances with Dubai Air Navigation Services (DANS).

Article (19) - Radio Frequencies and Communication Links

Unmanned aircraft operators must utilize licensed frequency bands authorized by the Telecommunications and Digital Government Regulatory Authority (TDRA). Drones utilizing public commercial cellular networks (4G/5G) must maintain continuous command-and-control (C2) link integrity meeting statutory QoS thresholds.

Article (25) - Obligations of UAS Operators & Incident Notice

Operators must maintain an approved emergency contingency plan for loss-of-control, ensure third-party liability insurance coverage for all commercial flights, and immediately report all airspace incursions, dropped links, or telemetry failures to DCAA and security authorities (Incident Notice Art. 25.14).

Article (26) - Airspace Safety & Separation Minima

All autonomous drone flights must observe strict separation minima: 500 feet vertical clearance from prohibited airspace and 1,000 meters horizontal buffer from manned aviation corridors and infrastructure.

Article (31) - Manned Aircraft Right-of-Way & Airspace Restrictions

Manned aircraft, emergency medical services (HEMS air ambulance), civil defense, and police operations possess absolute, non-negotiable right-of-way over all unmanned aircraft. Unmanned systems must yield corridor precedence immediately upon detection.

Article (36) - Privacy Protection and Surveillance Safeguards

It is strictly prohibited to record, photograph, store, or transmit video, audio, or sensory imagery of individuals, residential premises, or private properties without explicit legal consent. Data collected during commercial flight must undergo automated pseudonymization and privacy redaction before storage.

Articles (38)-(40) - Civil Liability & Compensation for Damage

The operator and remote pilot shall be strictly liable for any personal injury, property damage, or consequential loss resulting from drone operations, equipment failure, or loss of command link.